Travel Agents: Taiwan — Rules

A crowded market of rival travel agencies, all chasing the same food stalls in one eating day. Ride between four regions, gather ingredients, and pile Followers on the stalls you want. Win a stall by drawing the biggest crowd — out-committing every rival there — and it joins your tour and makes the next one cheaper. Your only points are the Bookings you run: complete the most before the last train and you're Top Agent.



These are real Taiwanese dishes and night markets — celebrated with care. Eat them with a grin.

3–6 players · 30–45 min

1. What you're going for

Your score is your Bookings, and nothing else. A Booking is a little tour you promise to run — three breakfast stalls, a ★ marquee name. Complete it and it scores its value; leave it unfinished and it costs you. Vendors, Followers, and your dial are pure engine and never score. Most Booking points when the last train leaves is Top Agent (§9).

2. Setup

> 🖼 [FIG-SETUP] — the shared board with its callouts.

Everything sits on one shared board, readable from any seat. Everyone starts in Taipei (North).

- The map — four regions in a ring: North 北 · Central 中 · South 南 · East 東. Ring-neighbours are linked; the HSR also links North and South directly.
- Ingredient markets — each region has a face-down market deck. Split each into DAY and NIGHT piles; shuffle the DAY into place, set the NIGHT aside for dusk. Six kinds of ingredient grow across the island (§3).
- Vendor stalls — fill the face-up slots from each region's DAY vendor deck (counts below); set the NIGHT vendor decks aside for dusk.
- Booking decks — shuffle the DAY 開團 and NIGHT 開團 decks separately to your count's size, then seed the 黃昏 DUSK card at the DAY deck's bottom and 末班車 LAST TRAIN at the NIGHT deck's bottom — your clock (§8). Deal a face-up Booking row from the DAY deck.
- Followers — a shared supply pool (below). Set every Followers-max dial to its start value 2 (the Influencer 網紅 starts at 4).
- Each player takes a character board (read its ability and flaw aloud), a pawn in Taipei, an empty Larder face-up, and their COMPLETED 成團 and CANCELLED 取消 pile markers.

The setup chart on the board gives, for your player count, the vendor slots per region, the Followers supply, and the DAY / NIGHT Booking-

deck sizes. There are deliberately fewer stalls than agents, so you'll collide over them. First player is whoever ate street food most recently, then clockwise; the Influencer 網紅 always takes the last seat.

3. Your turn

Take ONE action. Then, if your Larder holds more than 7 ingredients, discard down to 7.

- VISIT the market (where you stand) — flip the top 3 of this region's market. Any event fires now (§7), then discards. Keep 2 ingredients (the Big Eater 大胃王 keeps 3).
- CONVENIENCE STORE (anywhere) — flip the top 1 of any market: take the ingredient, or its event fires.
- TRAVEL — move to a neighbour (or North↔South by HSR), then flip the top 1 where you arrive (an event on arrival does nothing). Raise your dial +1.
- PROMOTE (with a vendor here) — place 2 Followers from the supply onto vendor(s) you stand with (§4).
- BRIBE a vendor (with it) — win a stall you've drawn the biggest crowd for (§5).
- BOOK a tour — take a Booking into your hand (§6).

> Greedy Grab. On a Visit or Convenience Store, keep one extra ingredient beyond your limit — your dial drops 1 (the crowd tuts and drifts; never below your start value).

> **Characters bend the rules.** Each board has one ability and one flaw for that player alone; where a board disagrees with these rules, the board wins. Some agents are flaw-free by design.

4. Followers & the dial

Followers are the hype you pile on a stall. They live only in the supply or stacked on a vendor — never in hand — and everyone may pile onto the same stall, in full view.

> **Your crowd can't outrun your dial.** Your total committed Followers, across every vendor, can never pass your Followers-max — the number on your dial (a ceiling, not a score). Travel and some events raise it; winning a vendor returns those Followers to the supply, freeing the ceiling; losing a fight lowers it (§5).

5. Bribing a vendor — the biggest crowd wins

A face-up vendor goes to whoever draws the biggest crowd for it. To Bribe a vendor you stand with:

1. hold strictly more committed Followers on it than any other agent — an outright majority (a tie claims nothing; the Big Brother 大哥 alone wins on a tie);
2. pay its ingredients, minus your region discounts.

Take the vendor onto your tour. If it satisfies a Booking you hold, complete it now (§6). Then return your Followers on it to the supply — and, the instant a contested stall is claimed, each losing agent takes their Followers back to supply and drops their dial: −1 by day, −2 at night (the crowd drifts to your rival's stall; never below your start value). Refill the slot.

A tie just blocks. Level for the biggest crowd? None may claim it (the Big Brother aside) — Promote again to break it, or walk away and let your Followers ride.

A won vendor is pure engine; it never scores. Most show a region icon: each icon you hold makes that region's ingredients 1 cheaper to Bribe — your ramp. Drinks and ★ apex stalls carry no icon. Night stalls cost more and often want two regions' ingredients.

> Trending 爆紅. An event can drop a Trending marker on a stall; win it and your dial rises +1 (it went viral). The printed ★ apex stalls are a separate, permanent thing — a region's top table.
>
> Rave Reviews 好評. The first time you complete your 2nd tour, raise your dial +1; at your 4th, take 1 ingredient of choice and your next Bribe costs 1 less. Once each, per player.

6. Bookings — your tours

A Booking (開團) is a tour you line up and try to run. Book a tour takes one card from the face-up row into your hand, then refills it. Hold at most 3.

- Complete it (成團). The moment your won vendors satisfy a held Booking, flip it to your COMPLETED 成團 pile — it scores its full value, nudges your Tours-Completed meter, and frees a hand slot.
- Cancel it (取消). At your 3-Booking limit and want a new one? Cancel a held Booking: set it in your CANCELLED 取消 pile, where it costs you half its value at scoring.

Held Bookings stay with you across dusk and can still be completed at night.

7. Markets & events

Each region's market holds its foods plus a few events, mostly small hazards. Working a market — a Visit or a Convenience Store — fires any event you flip, at once. A card flipped as you arrive on a Travel does nothing.

- Hazards tax or delay — they never take what you already hold, nor cost a whole turn.
- Boons hand out an ingredient or Followers, nudge your dial, or send a stall Trending.

> Who an event hits — read from the region the card came out of: ⦿ You · ⬢ This region (everyone standing there) · ➤ Next door (a

neighbour). At a Convenience Store you may be elsewhere, so ⬢ can land on a rival — not an attack, just the island living its day.

排班保養 Scheduled Maintenance (island-wide — its own banner). The HSR is down for everyone. Until the start of your next turn, North and South aren't linked — everyone travels the long way round the ring. Then it reopens. (The Globetrotter 阿嬤 is immune.)

8. The day-clock — dusk & the last train

It's one eating day, and the Booking decks are the clock: the day's tours book out, then the night's.

- Daytime 白天 — morning food and drinks; build your ramp.
- 黃昏 DUSK — when the DAY deck runs out, its 黃昏 DUSK card surfaces: finish the current turn, then flip to night — clear the unclaimed day vendors and markets, bring the night vendors and markets online, and deal a new Booking row from the NIGHT deck. Keep your Larder and Bookings.
- Night Market 夜市 — the big stalls: pricier, fought-over, the ★ apex.
- 末班車 LAST TRAIN — when the NIGHT deck runs out, its 末班車 LAST TRAIN card surfaces: finish the current round so all have had equal turns, then the game ends.

9. Scoring

Total each player once:

- + the full value of every Booking in your COMPLETED 成團 pile — the tours that ran.
- − half the value (rounded down) of every Booking in your CANCELLED 取消 pile; any Booking still unfinished in hand at the last train is cancelled too.

Vendors, Followers, and your dial score nothing. Most points is Top Agent; ties break to most vendors, then most regions covered, then fewest cancelled Bookings.

The six agents

Everyone plays the same game with one twist. Each board states its agent's exact ability and flaw; in short:

- The Old Councillor 里長伯 — pick one home region; Bribing there costs 1 less, elsewhere 2 more (the away tax).
- The Homebody 媽寶 — sole on-the-move sourcer: on a Travel, draw the top 2 of the region you left and keep both (event whiffs).
- The Big Eater 大胃王 — on a Visit, keep all 3 (may grab a 4th). Flaw: hazards fire twice on his Visit.
- The Influencer 網紅 — dial starts at 4, never drops below 4. Flaw: takes the last seat.
- The Big Brother 大哥 — he wins ties (need only match the biggest crowd).

- The Globetrotter 阿嬤 — her Travel reaches any region in one action; immune to Scheduled Maintenance.

FAQ

- A lost fight would drop my dial below my committed Followers. After the −1 / −2 drop (floored at your start value), return Followers from the board — your choice which — until your committed total is within your dial. A bad-review event works the same way.
- A market or Booking deck runs out. Reshuffle a market's discard — ingredients never leave the game. The Booking decks never reshuffle: their boundary card is the clock (§8).
- DUSK trips while I still hold day Bookings. Keep them — they carry into the night and can still be completed.
- Can a vendor, a full dial, or a ★ apex stall score? No. Only Bookings score.